

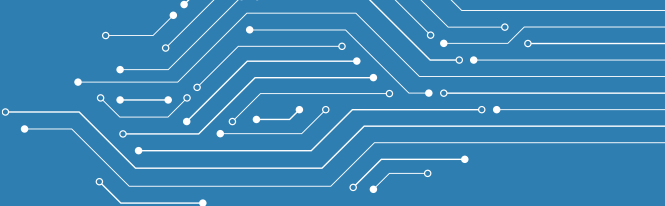


هيئة الحكومة الرقمية
Digital Government Authority

Strategic Directions for Digital Government

March 9, 2022





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“ My main goal is to turn our country into a model representing success. A world leader at all levels, I will work with you to make it happen.”

**The Custodian of the Two Holy Mosques His Royal Highness
King Salman bin Abdulaziz Al Saud**



“ Our ambition is to build a more prosperous nation, in which every citizen finds what he desires. The future of our nation, which we build together, will not be accepted unless we place it at the forefront of countries.”

**The Crown Prince, His Royal Highness
Prince Mohammed bin Salman bin Abdulaziz Al Saud**



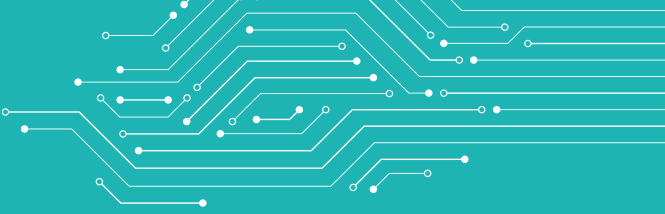
“ I extend my heartfelt thanks and gratitude to the Custodian of the Two Holy Mosques and His Royal Highness the Crown Prince, may Allah protect them, for the great support provided to the digital government in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.”

**H.E. the Chairman of the Board of Directors of Digital Government Authority
Eng. Abdullah bin Amer Alswaha**



“ The strategic directions contribute to improving the quality of life, raising the satisfaction rate of beneficiaries, facilitating doing business, enhancing competitiveness, raising the efficiency of government performance, activating e-participation, increasing the contribution to the GDP, and supporting the sustainability of natural resources by reducing carbon emissions, with the aim that the kingdom of Saudi Arabia become one of the leading 10 countries in digital government globally by 2030. ”

**H.E. the Governor of Digital Government Authority
Eng. Ahmed bin Mohammad Al-Suwaiyan**



1. Introduction

Strategic Directions Document

This document explains the strategic directions taken by the digital government of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, which was developed by the Digital Government Authority in coordination with the relevant authorities to achieve set strategic goals and aspirations of the Kingdom, and become the leading digital government in the world. This objective will be achieved in two phases. The first phase aims to build the digital government of the future by accelerating its growth and enforcing governance and regulation, while the second phase aims to achieve excellence in digital government services and reach global leadership in international indicators and standings.

Digital Government Authority

The Digital Government Authority was established following a Cabinet decision on March 9, 2021 corresponding to Rajab 25, 1442H. The Digital Government Authority (DGA) is the competent and national reference for all Digital Government related activities. DGA aims to regulate Digital Government activities in the government entities, to achieve a proactive Digital Government capable of providing highly efficient digital services, & achieve integration amongst government entities.

Introducing Digital Government

Digital government refers to the use of digital technologies as an integral part of the government's' strategies. It relies on a digital government ecosystem which supports the production of and access to data, services and content through interactions with government agencies according to a set of principles and dimensions, while remaining within the strategic directions set for the digital government. The digital government focuses on providing information and communication technologies, as well as systems, platforms and portals, to build, improve and enable easy access to government information and services, while maximizing quality and security. It aims to do so by enhancing community participation to support the development of administrative, organizational and operational processes within government sectors, and adopting innovative business models and flexible policies and standards that promote digital transformation and excellence.

2. Ambitions and Aspirations

2.1 Alignment with the Kingdom's Vision 2030 and other national digital strategies

The National Digital Government Strategy was built and designed in line with national directions and aspirations

Linkage to Vision 2030

Contribution to L1 Vision 2030 Objectives



Enhance Government Effectiveness



Grow and Diversify the Economy



Offer a Fulfilling and Healthy Life

Contribution to L2 Vision 2030 Objectives

Non-Exhaustive



Improving the performance of the gov. ecosystem



Effective Interaction with Citizens



Unlocking the capabilities of the promising non-oil sectors

Direct Contribution to L3 Vision 2030 Objectives

5.2.4 Develop the E-Government

5.3.3 Ensure responsiveness of government entities to stakeholders' feedback

Indirect Contribution to L3 Vision 2030 Objectives

Non-Exhaustive

3.3.2 Develop the digital economy

4.3.1 Nurture and support the innovation culture

4.3.2 Grow SME contribution to the economy

5.2.1 Design a leaner and more effective gov. structure

3.1.1 Ease of Doing Business

Linkage to VRPs



NTP 2.0



Quality of Life



Human Capability Development



Health Sector Transformation



National Industrial Development and Logistics



Doyof Al Rahman



Fiscal Sustainability

Linkage to Digital Strategies*

Digital Strategies



NDTS



NSDAIA



ICT Strategy



Cybersecurity Strategy



CITC

Enabling Activities

Accelerates government efficiency through technology

Stimulates Data & AI adoption

Drives tech innovation and enhances digital literacy

Enables a resilient digital infrastructure

Enable digital transformation through a regulated digital telecommunications infrastructure

Source: Vision 2030 website, National Digital Transformation Strategy, SDAIA Strategy, ICT Strategy, National Cybersecurity Strategy

*Some of the strategies are still in the review and approval process

2.2 Contribution to UN's sustainable development goals

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are a list of 17 global goals that focus on economic development, social inclusion and environmental protection



Good Health & Wellbeing

Ensuring good health and wellbeing for citizens, and thus improving their quality of life.

Strategic directions will improve quality of healthcare services and contribute to promotion of wellbeing and healthy lifestyle



Decent Work & Economic Growth

Promotion of sustained, inclusive and sustainable economic growth.

Strategic directions will directly contribute to GDP and Jobs through both direct investment and improvement of competitiveness



Sustainable Cities And Communities

Improving the sustainability of urban development.

Strategic directions with citizen centric focus will enable communities and cities to become more sustainable



Peace, Justice & Strong Institutions

Ensuring peace, justice and strong institutions. It calls for institutions to be transparent.

Strategic directions will strengthen public institutions, provide transparency to beneficiaries and contribute to decrease in corruption



Quality Education

Ensuring inclusive and equitable quality education for all.

Strategic directions will improve quality of educational services and improve the efficiency of citizen/teacher interaction



Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure

Building resilient infrastructure, promoting inclusive and sustainable industrialization, and fostering innovation.

Strategic directions will play a key role in leveraging innovation and building resilient infrastructure



Climate Action

Taking urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts.

Strategic directions will create a net positive impact on the environment and increase KSA's EPI score



Partnerships to achieve the goals

Partnering and cooperating at an international level to achieve set goals.

Strategic directions will focus on creating added value from international and local strategic partnerships

2.3 Outcomes of stakeholder engagement in formulating strategic directions

Based on questionnaires and workshops, the strategic directions won the approval of the parties who attended the workshops, where the average satisfaction rate reached 4 out of 5, and below are the most prominent recommendations:



Clarification of the DGS Governance Model

The government system is manifold, and the overlap between agencies is large, and one of the main challenges lies in the effective governance of roles



Alignment to National Strategies

The DGS should be clearly aligned on multiple angles with the national strategies



Facilitation of Funding

It is recommended to rely on VRP and DGA rather than on other entities to avoid bureaucracy and facilitate funding



DGS Execution

Challenges were faced on NDTs to on-board sectorial committees, and thus DGA should be aware of that.



Impact of challenges on digital economy

The impact of the digital government on the economy is still induced or indirect, and this should be changed



Improvement of Customer Satisfaction

Customer satisfaction is always change, service charges are duplicated, and platforms are redundant. The process should be streamlined and unified



Unheard Voice of Business

The VoB is not properly heard resulting in private sector needs and requirements being not adequately met.



Strong Competition from Gov.

Private sector suffers from strong competition from government companies leading to less opportunity to engage on mega projects.



PPP is Essential

The adoption of PPP models strengthens the relationship between private sector and government



Localization of Content

The DGS should align with the national localization strategy, in order developed frameworks to incentivize the localization of content

3. Benchmarking and Current State

3.1 Benchmarking - Summary and Key Findings

Leading digital governments around the world were able to improve the maturity levels of their digital government by enhancing digital capabilities and IT infrastructure, in addition to adopting emerging technology solutions

Countries



Denmark



Estonia



Australia



South Korea



United Kingdom

Themes



Ensuring
Advanced Digital
Skills



Improving Digital
Inclusion



Investing in the
Digital Economy



Ensuring Public
participation



Having Unified
Platforms

Main Observations

Leading governments have formed alliances, partnerships or special task forces, focused on addressing digital skills gaps, such as the Danish National Alliance for Digital Skills and Jobs

Some countries have worked to include principles of digital inclusion in their legislation, such as the e-Estonia Charter which requires the provision of digital services to all segments of society, and formulating of criteria to monitor compliance verification

Leading governments are keen to stay aware of the latest technological developments. South Korea developed a master plan and updates it every 5 years to ensure that digital government services adopt the latest technologies

Leading governments have introduced legislations and/or strategies to ensure that their government takes into account the needs of their citizens

Leading governments established interoperability controls and technological standards to support inclusive government transformation and shared government platforms

Implications on the Kingdom

Bridging the gaps in terms of digital capabilities by introducing training programs at the government level and leveraging alliances with the private sector

Accelerating the pace of adoption of digital government services by directing campaigns encouraging the use of digital services by the demographically excluded segments of society

Encouraging and supporting government agencies to integrate emerging technologies such as blockchain, artificial intelligence, digital twin technology, and others

Focusing on the citizen needs by introducing effective communication channels with the beneficiaries to facilitate feedback collection and observations on government services

Moving towards inclusive government by gradually integrating existing government platforms and adopting an effective governance model that encourages the development of new platforms

3.2 Challenges and current state

Based on the results of the current state assessment and the benchmarking analysis, the DGA has developed a strategy that considers the most important enablers such as developing digital policies, building digital capabilities, adopting emerging technology solutions and others.



4. Strategic Directions

4.1 Vision

Our aspirations for the digital government have been embedded within the vision as follows

Placing Saudi Arabia amongst the top ten leading digital governments globally

A Pioneering Digital Government for an Enabled, and Vibrant Nation

Implementing advanced digital technologies in government agencies to improve day-to-day activities

Providing services that are focused on a beneficiary-centric approach to improve customer satisfaction

4.2 Mission

The mission embodies a purpose of how the digital government is looking to accomplish its vision

Providing an integrated and interconnected digital government ecosystem that improves decision making

To achieve seamless and **integrated** digital government services by leveraging the value of **technologies** and placing **beneficiaries** at the heart of the delivery

Placing beneficiaries' wants, needs, preferences, and expectations at the heart of Digital Government decision making

Encouraging the adoption of digital technologies to reap the benefits it offers and better address digital challenges

4.3 Digital Government Strategic Directions' Values

The values embody the different principles the digital government will instate in the government ecosystem

Participation

Government agencies shall promote citizen and private sector participation in order to generate transparency and increase beneficiary confidence in government institutions. Active participation is to be built upon consultation and exchange of basic information and enhancing the joint development processes, in addition to providing digital technologies to obtain innovative mechanisms that promote communication between all players.

Collaboration

Government agencies shall collaborate with other players in the government, non-profit, and private sectors through institutional interaction models, in order to identify gaps and priorities to deliver services to the beneficiaries. This will give the agencies the possibility to effectively assign human and financial resources who will target priority processes and areas where the demand is high before making new investment. Consequently, existing gaps between the (supply) government agencies and the (demand) beneficiaries and other stakeholders will be reduced, and this process will inevitably result in a higher beneficiary satisfaction with the services provided by government agencies.

Innovation

Government agencies shall strive to generate and incorporate new ideas and methods to enable & expedite the digital transformation processes and improve their services. Key beneficiaries of government services shall also be central in the development and transformation of all digital government services as well as central participants in the creation of new digital solutions.

Commitment

Government agencies and Ecosystem players shall provide their best efforts to achieve implementation of Digital Government policies and recommendations. They shall also follow the digital transformation models' policies and technical standards related to international indicators, under which the government agencies' compliance will be monitored, in addition to providing the consultation needed to contribute to increasing the level of adherence.

4.4 Objectives

Through the development of the Digital Government's Strategic Directions, the Kingdom aspires to achieve many goals, most notably:



Source: Qiyas 8 Report, EGDI United Nation (2020), National Transformation Program 2.0 Implementation Plan (2021-2025), IMD digital competitiveness report (2021).

4.5 NDGS pillars and main objectives

In order to achieve these overarching aspirations, the digital government needs to work extensively under 6 pillars

1 Satisfied Citizen

G2C

Provide seamless and effective government services to all beneficiaries. Beneficiaries will have a more personalized experience

2 Enabled Business

G2B

Improve ease of doing business within KSA, as well leverage available capabilities in order to improve the competitiveness of the private sector

3 Effective Government

G2G

Empower the government by adopting unified business models, launching national initiatives for digital government services

4 Efficient Investment

Unify shared resources and standards, improve the compliance and sustainability of ICT investments & procurements, and raise the return on investments

5 Regulated Ecosystem

Provide policy and legislation guidance and review to ensure future-proofing for an ever-changing digital government ecosystem

6 Expedited Transformation

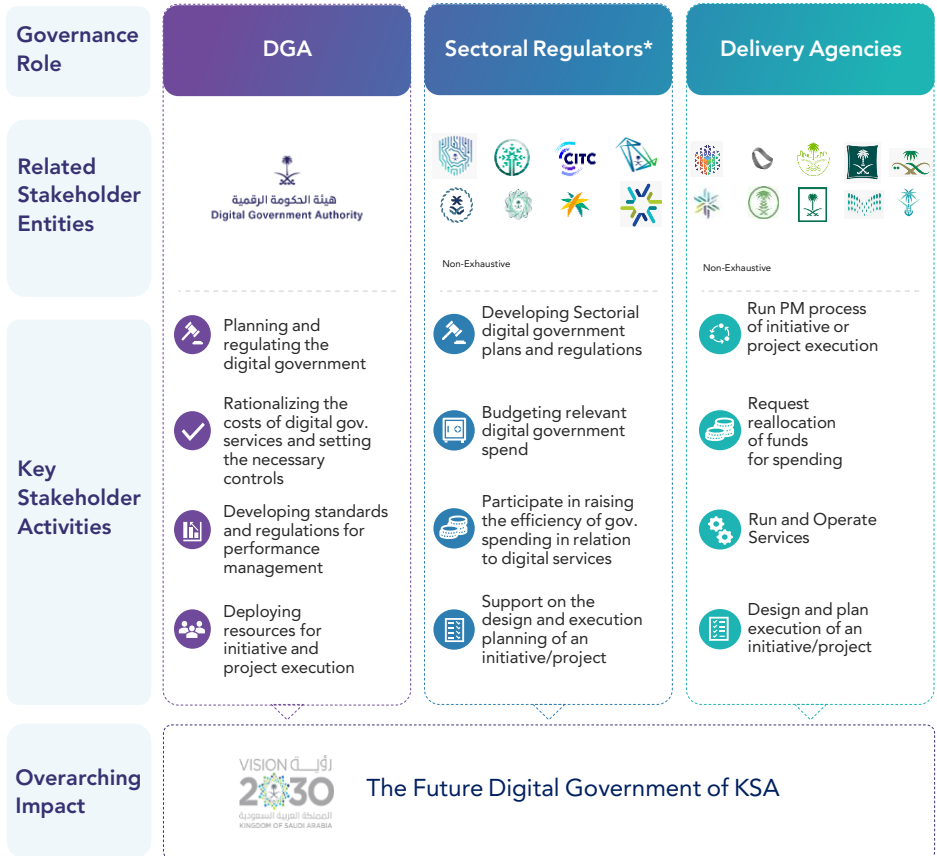
Enable the entire digital government strategy by leveraging an efficient communication approach, enhancing the digital infrastructure, as well as upskilling the digital workforce. Also, we can ensure a seamless integration in the government ecosystem by leveraging a robust governance model

5. Governance

5.1 Overarching Ecosystem Governance Model

The strategy cannot be executed in silos, hence a well-defined governance model in the ecosystem will need to be developed and adopted

Overarching Governance Ecosystem



* Coordination is made with the Digital Government Authority regarding all digital government work

5.2 NDGS pillars and main objectives

The proposed governance of the Digital Government Ecosystem is built around 4 elements describing authorities and governance pathways

Element	Description	DGA	Sectoral Regulators	Delivery Agencies
1 Plan and Regulate	Develop strategies and regulations for digital government plans, and review/approve the plans	R Developing and enforcing	A Implementing and cascading	C, I
2 Finance	Provide, oversee, and optimize financing related to digital government spending	R Approving and optimizing	A Implementing and cascading*	C, I
3 Implement and Operate	Plan and deploy resources, and run PM process for the execution of initiatives Provide direct services and/or run assets/systems	C, I	C, I	R, A Developing, launching
4 Manage Performance	Develop standards and regulations for performance management, report and audit the performance, and summarize in yearly report	R Monitoring	A Implementing and cascading*	C, I

* Roles and responsibilities will be detailed during the implementation phase of the strategy

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